

Seven Factors of Enlightenment

- Mindfulness ([*sati*](#))
- Investigation ([*dhamma vicaya*](#))
- Energy ([*viriya*](#))
- Joy or rapture ([*piti*](#))
- Relaxation or tranquillity [*passaddhi*](#)
- Concentration [*samadhi*](#)
- Equanimity [*upekkha*](#)

The Rupa Jhānas

1. **First Jhāna** - To attain this jhāna, the meditator must fix his mind on the meditation object to reduce and eliminate the lower mental qualities which is called the [*Five Hindrances*](#) (sensual desire, ill will, sloth and torpor, restlessness and worry, and doubt) and promote the growth of five jhāna factors ([*applied/directed thought*](#), [*sustained thought*](#), [*rapture*](#), [*bliss*](#) and [*one-pointedness*](#)). In this stage, only the subtlest mental movement remains. The ability to form unwholesome intentions ceases.
2. **Second Jhāna** - To attain this jhāna, the meditator must reduce and eliminate the two initial factors of the first jhāna itself ([*applied/directed thought*](#) and [*sustained thought*](#)), the three remaining jhāna factors still possessed by the meditator are the [*rapture*](#), [*bliss*](#) and [*one-pointedness*](#). In this stage, all mental movement utterly ceases. The ability to form wholesome intentions ceases as well. Acquires complete confidence.
3. **Third Jhāna** - To attain this jhāna, the meditator must reduce and eliminate the third initial factor of the first jhāna itself ([*rapture*](#)), the two remaining jhāna factors still possessed by the meditator are the [*bliss*](#) and [*one-pointedness*](#). Three additional components are possessed by the meditator ([*equanimity*](#), mindfulness and discernment).
4. **Fourth Jhāna** - To attain this *jhāna*, the meditator must reduce and eliminate the fourth initial factor of the first *jhāna* itself ([*bliss*](#)) and replace it with another *jhāna* factor ([*equanimity/neutral feeling*](#)), the two remaining *jhāna* factors still possessed by the meditator are the [*neutral feeling*](#) and [*one-pointedness*](#). In this stage, the meditator enters a state of supreme purity, equanimity, and pure consciousness.

[\[edit\]](#) Arupa Jhānas: The Formless Spheres

Beyond the four *jhāna* lie four higher attainments in the scale of concentration, usually referred in commentarial literature as the *Arupa Jhāna* (Immaterial/formless Jhāna). The *immaterial jhānas* are designated as:

1. Dimension of infinite space.
2. Dimension of infinite consciousness.
3. Dimension of nothingness.
4. Dimension of neither perception nor non-perception.

The threefold division of the path

The Noble Eightfold Path is sometimes divided into three basic divisions, as follows:^[6]

<i>Division</i>	<i>Eightfold Path factors</i>	<i>Acquired factors</i>
Wisdom (Sanskrit: <i>prajñā</i> , Pāli: <i>paññā</i>)	1. Right view	9. Right knowledge
	2. Right intention	10. Right liberation
Ethical conduct (Sanskrit: <i>śīla</i> , Pāli: <i>sīla</i>)	3. Right speech	
	4. Right action	
	5. Right livelihood	
Concentration (Sanskrit and Pāli: <i>samādhi</i>)	6. Right effort	
	7. Right mindfulness	
	8. Right concentration	